

Playwright - Installation & Setup

A complete guide to prepare the environment, install, configure, validate and perform the first functional use of the tool.

Manual objective

This manual guides you through the complete installation and setup process, from preparing the environment to final validation. Follow the steps in order and use the checks throughout the guide to confirm that each configuration was completed correctly.

Official references

<https://playwright.dev/>

<https://playwright.dev/docs/intro>

First test

Create a .spec.ts file, navigate with page.goto, prefer getByRole/getByLabel and assert with expect. Run npx playwright test and inspect the HTML report.

Best practices and troubleshooting

Keep tests independent, use resilient locators, isolate data, control authentication state and investigate flaky tests rather than hiding them.

Installation — prerequisites

Install a supported Node.js version and validate node --version and npm --version. Create or enter the project directory before initializing Playwright.

Install browsers

Run npx playwright install to download browser binaries compatible with the installed Playwright version. Linux/CI may require additional dependencies.

Validate installation

Run npx playwright test. Use npx playwright test --ui when useful and npx playwright show-report for the HTML report.

Troubleshooting

If npx is not recognized, validate Node/npm and PATH. If browsers are missing, run npx playwright install. Avoid copying node_modules across operating systems.